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PROCESSING LABEL HERE

Write your **student number** in the boxes above. **Letter**

Theatre Studies

Question and Answer Book

VCE Examination – Tuesday 18 November 2025

- Reading time is **15 minutes**: 9.00 am to 9.15 am
- Writing time is **1 hour 30 minutes**: 9.15 am to 10.45 am

Approved materials

- Coloured pencils, water-based pens and markers
- Protractors, compass, set squares and aids for curve sketching
- An English and/or bilingual printed dictionary

Materials supplied

- Question and Answer Book of 20 pages
- Detachable Insert for Section A in the centrefold

Instructions

- Detach the Insert from the centre of this book during reading time.
- You **may** support **any** of your answers with illustrations and/or diagrams.
- Use the additional space at the end of this book if you need extra space to complete a response.
- At the end of the examination you may keep the detachable Insert.

Students are **not** permitted to bring mobile phones and/or any unauthorised electronic devices into the examination room.

Contents pages

Section A (2 questions, 30 marks) 2–9
Section B (1 question, 10 marks) 10–12
Section C (1 question, 10 marks) 14–15

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VICTORIAN CURRICULUM AND ASSESSMENT AUTHORITY

VICTORIA State Government

Section A

Instructions

- Remove the Insert from the centre of this book during reading time.
- Use the information in the Insert to answer the questions in Section A.
- Answer **all** questions in the spaces provided.
- Write your responses in English.

Do not write in this area.

Question 1 (20 marks)

Shade the box for **one** production role to interpret the production of *The Tempest*. This production role must be **different** from the production role selected for Question 2.

- ☐ 1. actor
- ☐ 2. director
- ☐ 3. designer: costume
- ☐ 4. designer: hair and make-up
- ☐ 5. designer: props
- ☐ 6. designer: set
- ☐ 7. designer: lighting
- ☐ 8. designer: sound

Planning

Your production team will recontextualise *The Tempest* to reflect the attitudes, beliefs and values of a contemporary Australian audience. The team might consider recontextualising an aspect of the play such as character(s), setting(s), time period, plot points or any other part of the play.

Shade the box(es) for **one or more** of the following themes from *The Tempest* that are relevant to a contemporary Australian audience.

- ☐ revenge and forgiveness
- ☐ environmental challenges
- ☐ freedom and restriction
- ☐ use and misuse of power
- ☐ colonisation

a. Explain how you would apply your selected production role to recontextualise **one or more** aspects of *The Tempest*.

In your response, refer to:

- your selected theme(s)
- **one or more** images or a direct quotation(s) from the dramaturgy in the Insert. 4 marks

Question 1 continues on the next page.

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The Tempest begins with a storm scene.

A production aim is for the storm scene to create a feeling of chaos and confusion for the audience.

Circumstances surrounding the storm scene described in Script excerpt 1 on page 2 of the Insert:

- Prospero seeks revenge on a king who had exiled Prospero from their home country.
- Ariel, a spirit with magical powers, is an enslaved servant of Prospero.
- Prospero sends Ariel to control a storm that will shipwreck the king and his son.
- Ariel recounts how they used their magical powers to control the storm.

The character of Prospero might be played as any gender identity.

The character of Ariel might be played as any gender identity and/or may be played by a group of actors.

Shade the box(es) to select **one or more** of the following moments in the storm scene described by Ariel in Script excerpt 1 to answer **parts b–e**.

☐ Ariel transforming magically into fire – in cabins, on the mast and in different positions on the ship – to frighten the sailors

☐ Ariel dividing magically to appear in different places at the same time

☐ Ariel joining back together to form one flame

☐ Ariel moving faster than lightning

☐ Ariel creating a sound so deafening that it frightens the sailors

☐ The sailors jumping into the ocean in terror

b. During the planning stage, explain how work in your selected production role could realise the storm scene.

In your response, refer to:

- a planning activity relevant to your selected production role
- your selected moment(s) in the storm scene
- the recontextualisation explained in **part a**.

4 marks

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Development

c. During the development stage, describe how work in your selected production role could apply motion to rehearse, trial or experiment with an idea to realise the storm scene.

In your response, refer to:

- **one or more** activities used to rehearse, trial or experiment with an idea
- the element of motion. 3 marks

d. During the development stage, describe how work in your selected production role could apply theatre technologies to refine the idea explored in **part c**.

In your response, refer to:

- **one or more** activities used to refine the idea
- theatre technologies. 3 marks

Question 1 continues on the next page.

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Presentation

e. A production aim is to ensure safe, ethical, inclusive and/or sustainable work practices during the staging of the storm scene.

During the presentation stage, explain how work in your selected production role could achieve this production aim.

In your response, refer to:

- the chaos and confusion conveyed in the storm scene
- **one or more** activities during the technical or dress rehearsals to refine the scene
- the performance
- the impact(s) on the production team and/or the audience. 6 marks

Do not write in this area.

Question 2 (10 marks)

Shade the box for **one** production role to interpret the production of *The Tempest*. This production role must be **different** from the production role selected for Question 1.

- ☐ 1. actor
- ☐ 2. director
- ☐ 3. designer: costume
- ☐ 4. designer: hair and make-up
- ☐ 5. designer: props
- ☐ 6. designer: set
- ☐ 7. designer: lighting
- ☐ 8. designer: sound

Caliban is enslaved by Prospero. In Script excerpt 2, Caliban angrily criticises Prospero for taking over the island that was promised to Caliban by Caliban's mother.

The character of Caliban might be played as any gender identity and/or may be played by a group of actors.

Question 2 continues on the next page.

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Script excerpt 2

Script excerpt 2 contains both the original Shakespearean text and a modern-day translation. Either or both versions can be used when referencing the script excerpt.

Act I Scene 2, lines 397–411 and 433–435

Original	**Modern**
CALIBAN	CALIBAN
This island's mine, by Sycorax my mother, Which thou takest from me.	This island is mine, given to me by my mother Sycorax. You took it from me.
When thou camest first, Thou strok'st me and made much of me, wouldst give me Water with berries in 't,	When you first came here, you petted me and treated me well. You would give me water with berries in it,
and teach me how To name the bigger light, and how the less, That burn by day and night.	and you taught me the names for the sun burning in the daytime sky and the moon which lights the night.
And then I loved thee And showed thee all the qualities o' th' isle, The fresh springs, brine pits, barren place and fertile.	I loved you then, and I showed you all the features of the island—the freshwater springs, the saltwater pits, the places that were good for growing things and those that were not.
Cursed be I that did so! All the charms Of Sycorax, toads, beetles, bats, light on you!	A curse on me for doing all that! May all the evil spells of Sycorax torment you with toads, beetles, and bats!
For I am all the subjects that you have, Which first was mine own king.	I'm the only subject you have on this island, where once I was my own king.
And here you sty me In this hard rock, whiles you do keep from me The rest o' th' island. […]	And now you keep me confined in this cave and don't let me go anywhere else on the island. […]
You taught me language, and my profit on 't Is I know how to curse.	You taught me language, and all I gained from it is that I now know how to curse.
The red plague rid you For learning me your language!	May you die of the plague for teaching me your language!

Source: B Florman, 'The Tempest: A Shakescleare Translation', *LitCharts*, LitCharts LLC, 1 May 2014, <www.litcharts.com/shakescleare/shakespeare-translations/the-tempest/act-1-scene-2>
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a. Explain how work in your selected production role could interpret Script excerpt 2 to realise a specific quality or trait of Caliban.

In your response, refer to:

- a specific quality or trait of Caliban
- a direct quotation of **one or more** lines of dialogue from Script excerpt 2
- an interrelationship with **one or more** other production roles. 5 marks

b. Explain how work in your selected production role could apply emphasis to realise Caliban's status in Script excerpt 2.

In your response, refer to:

- emphasis
- a direct quotation of **one or more** lines of dialogue from Script excerpt 2
- **one or more** aspects of the dramaturgy in the Insert. 5 marks

End of Section A

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Section B

Instructions

- The question in Section B is based on plays from the VCE Theatre Studies playlist.
- Answer the question in the space provided.
- Write your response in English.

Shade the box for **one** play from the 2025 VCE Theatre Studies playlist. This play must be **different** from the play selected for Section C.

☐ 1. Three Sisters
☐ 2. Jekyll and Hyde
☐ 3. Henry V
☐ 4. The Birds
☐ 5. Love and Information
☐ 6. SUPER
☐ 7. 1984 by George Orwell
☐ 8. Kimberly Akimbo
☐ 9. Pride and Prejudice
☐ 10. Yong

Question 1 (10 marks)

Shade the boxes for **two or more** production roles.

☐ 1. actor
☐ 2. designer: costume
☐ 3. designer: hair and make-up
☐ 4. designer: props
☐ 5. designer: set
☐ 6. designer: lighting
☐ 7. designer: sound

Evaluate how work in your selected production roles was applied to interpret **one or more** contexts of the written script in performance.

In your response, refer to:

- the context(s) of the written script
- the theatre style(s)
- **one or more** lines of dialogue or stage directions from the written script
- the play in performance.

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Question 1 continues on the next page.

End of Section B

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Examination continues on the next page.

Section C

Instructions

- The questions in Section C are based on plays from the VCE Theatre Studies playlist.
- Answer **all** questions in the spaces provided.
- Write your responses in English.

Shade the box for **one** play from the 2025 VCE Theatre Studies playlist. This play must be **different** from the play selected in Section B. You must refer to the **same** play in your responses to **part a** and **part b** of Question 1.

☐ 1. Three Sisters
☐ 2. Jekyll and Hyde
☐ 3. Henry V
☐ 4. The Birds
☐ 5. Love and Information
☐ 6. SUPER
☐ 7. 1984 by George Orwell
☐ 8. Kimberly Akimbo
☐ 9. Pride and Prejudice
☐ 10. Yong

Question 1 (10 marks)

Shade the box for **one or more** aspects of variation.

☐ variation: tension
☐ variation: conflict
☐ variation: intensity
☐ variation: energy
☐ variation: space

a. Analyse how your selected aspect(s) of variation was applied in **one or more** design decisions to realise the intended meaning of the play.

In your response, refer to **one or more** specific moments from the performance. 5 marks

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Shade the box for **one or more** aspects of rhythm.

☐ rhythm: pace

☐ rhythm: timing

☐ rhythm: tempo

b. Evaluate how **one or more** actors applied your selected aspect(s) of rhythm to establish, maintain and/or manipulate the actor–audience relationship.

In your response, refer to **one or more** specific moments from the performance. 5 marks

End of examination questions

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Extra space for responses

Clearly **number** all responses in this space.

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If you use any additional Question and Answer Books to complete your responses, write your **student number** on the front cover. At the end of the examination, place the additional Question and Answer Books inside the front cover of the first Question and Answer Book.

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Insert for Theatre Studies Section A

Please remove from the centre of this book during reading time.

Dramaturgy

The production team has collated the following information, images and Script excerpt 1 through a dramaturgical process.

The Tempest

The Tempest, by William Shakespeare, was written in the early 1600s and is one of his final plays.

Plot

- The play is set on a remote magical island.
- Prospero, a powerful magician, was the Duke of Milan before being exiled by their sibling Antonio. Antonio becomes the Duke of Milan.
- Prospero is now stranded on the island, though they control the island and the magical beings who had lived there before they arrived.
- To take revenge against Antonio, and using their magic, Prospero conjures a storm that shipwrecks Antonio (the Duke), Alonso (the King), Ferdinand (the King's child) and others on the island.
- Prospero enlists a magical spirit servant, Ariel, and a slave, Caliban, to help get revenge and regain power.

Context

- *The Tempest* was written at a time when new shipping routes were being established from Europe to the 'unknown world' (for example, parts of Asia and Africa).
- European society was largely led by powerful men.
- Countries would use their power to take control of new lands and their inhabitants, and impose their own laws and beliefs.
- Caliban is native to the island, which belonged to Caliban before Prospero arrived.
- Prospero's control of the island, and manipulation of Caliban and Ariel, has been interpreted as representing colonisation.

Styles

In its original context, the play was performed in the style of Elizabethan Theatre, which included the following conventions:

- stylised and exaggerated movements and gestures
- detailed and vibrant costumes to indicate character status
- natural lighting and minimal sets
- performing on a thrust stage, fostering a closer relationship with the audience

Contemporary interpretations

Contemporary theatre productions have responded to a range of contexts and purposes. Examples of contemporary theatre include:

- Post-Colonial Theatre – recontextualising the depiction of oppressed or colonised people, particularly through the production design of the island and interpretation of Caliban
- Feminist Theatre – recontextualising the depictions of women and gender-diverse people, particularly through the casting of non-male-identifying actors to play Prospero.

Script excerpt 1

Script excerpt 1 contains both the original Shakespearean text and a modern-day translation. Either or both versions can be used when referencing the script excerpt.

Act I Scene 2, lines 224–256

Original	**Modern**
ARIEL All hail, great master! …	ARIEL Greetings, great master! …
[…]	[…]
PROSPERO Hast thou, spirit, Performed to point the tempest that I bade thee?	PROSPERO Spirit, have you created and controlled the storm exactly as I told you to?
ARIEL To every article. I boarded the king's ship. Now on the beak, Now in the waist, the deck, in every cabin, I flamed amazement.	ARIEL Down to the last detail. I boarded the king's ship. And from the prow, to the middle of the ship, to the stern, and in every cabin, I took the form of a fire and sent everyone into a terror.
Sometime I'd divide, And burn in many places. On the topmast, The yards, and bowsprit would I flame distinctly, Then meet and join.	Sometimes I would divide myself, and burn at many places at once. I burned on the main mast, the yards extending from the mast—and, at the same time, split to burn the bowsprit extending from the prow. Then I joined back together to form a single flame.
[…] The fire and cracks Of sulfurous roaring the most mighty Neptune Seem to besiege and make his bold waves tremble …	[…] The fire and deafening cracks of my burning seemed to terrify even mighty Neptune, the god of the sea, and made his waves tremble …
[…] Not a soul But felt a fever of the mad and played Some tricks of desperation.	[…] Every person on the ship was like a madman and did desperate things.
All but mariners Plunged in the foaming brine and quit the vessel, Then all afire with me. The king's son, Ferdinand, With hair up-staring—then, like reeds, not hair—	Everyone except the sailors jumped into the rough sea to escape the ship that I had set on fire. The king's son, Ferdinand, with his hair standing straight up—looking like reeds instead of hair—
Was the first man that leaped, cried, "Hell is empty And all the devils are here."	was the first one who jumped, shouting, "Hell is empty, and all the devils are here!"

Source: B Florman, 'The Tempest: A Shakescleare Translation', *LitCharts*, LitCharts LLC, 1 May 2014, <www.litcharts.com/shakescleare/shakespeare-translations/the-tempest/act-1-scene-2>

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Images

Image 1

Image 2

Image 3

Sources

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Image 4

Image 5

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Sources

4: Wanda Gibson, *Twelve Turtles*, Hopevale Art Centre, <digital-classroom.nma.gov.au/images/twelve-turtles-wanda-gibson> Courtesy of National Museum of Australia

5: Roma Thompson, *Card houses*, oil canvas on board, 1972, Geelong Gallery, <www.geelonggallery.org.au/collection/explore-the-collection/roma-thompson>

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